

Jesus, the Very Thought of Thee

- 1 Jesus, the very thought of thee
with sweetness fills my breast;
but sweeter far thy face to see,
and in thy presence rest.
- 2 Nor voice can sing, nor heart can frame,
nor can the memory find,
a sweeter sound than thy blest name,
O Savior of mankind.
- 3 O Hope of ev'ry contrite heart,
O Joy of all the meek,
to those who fall, how kind thou art!
How good to those who seek!
- 4 But what to those who find? Ah, this,
nor tongue nor pen can show:
the love of Jesus, what it is,
none but his loved ones know.
- 5 Jesus, our only joy be thou,
as thou our prize wilt be;
Jesus, be thou our glory now,
and through eternity.

Words: Latin hymn, 12th cent.; tr. Edward Caswall, 1849

Music: John B. Dykes, 1866

Tune: ST. AGNES · CM · Scripture: Ephesians 3:18-19

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